

American Mahjong Cheat Sheet

Every rule you need, one clean page

SETUP

4 players · 152 tiles · National Mah Jongg League card required · 13 tiles in hand, draw to 14 and discard.

READING THE CARD

Each line = one winning hand. Category (e.g. 2026, 2468, Consecutive Run) → hand pattern → points.

A hand must match a line on the CURRENT year's card to be valid.

THE CHARLESTON

First pass: pass 3 tiles right · Second pass: 3 left · Third (optional): 3 across. Then pass 1-2-3 (courtesy).

JOKERS & CLAIMING

Jokers substitute for any tile in a hand (never in a pair unless a pair is part of the hand).

Call 'Pung'/'Kong'/'Quint' for discards that complete a set; claim with the exact matching set.

QUICK RULES

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Pick & discard | ☐ One pair required |
| ☐ Expose on claim | ☐ Mah Jongg = highest win |
| ☐ Win by self-draw or discard | |

Reference only — always verify against the current NMJL card and local table rules.